Hong Kong Mahjong Association

GGHK Tournament Rules - 13-Tile Classical Hong Kong Mahjong

Unofficial English translation of the official Chinese rulebook

Source document title: GGHK 麻雀大賽 十三張清張麻雀規則

Last revised in source: 17 May 2023

This translation preserves the meaning and structure of the Chinese source as closely as possible, but it is not an officially issued English edition by the association.

Contents

- General Provisions
- Composition of the Mahjong Tiles
- Objective of a Mahjong Hand
- Tile Groupings
- Melds
- Winning Hand Shapes
- Phases of a Hand
- Dealing Phase
- Play Phase
- Settlement Phase
- Reaction Time
- Seating and Dealing
- Dice Counting
- Dealer and Winds
- Opening the Wall
- Dealing
- Table Areas
- Turn Sequence
- Discarding
- Draw-and-Discard Rules
- In-Play Calls
- Calls
- Pung
- Chow
- Kong
- Robbing a Kong
- Winning

• Settlement After Winning

• Call Priority

• Prohibited Calls

• Placement of Open Melds

• Robbing a Kong

• Winning a Hand

• Scoring a Win

• Drawn Hand

• End of a Round

• Fouls and Penalties

• Fouls During Dealing

• Fouls When Drawing

• Fouls During Play

• Dead Hand (Xianggong)

• Other Misconduct

• Score Calculation

• Basic Scoring Principles

• Point Transfer Method

• List of Fan

• 1 Fan

• 3 Fan

• 5 Fan

• 7 Fan

• Limit Hands (10 Fan)

• Points Conversion Table

• Copyright Notice

General Provisions

1. These rules serve as guidance for players and as the enforcement standard for referees.

- By entering this tournament, a player is deemed to have agreed to these rules.
- The referee has final authority on all rulings.

2. Players shall follow the rules and compete fairly.

- The penalties set out in these rules generally apply to unintentional or careless infractions.
- The referee may impose additional punishment for deliberate violations.

3. For most minor infractions or etiquette issues, a ruling will normally be made only if a player raises a complaint.

4. A player must raise a foul immediately.

- If another player has already drawn, mixed the tile into the concealed hand, called, or won so that correction is no longer possible, the act is treated as having taken effect. The prescribed penalty is applied and the hand continues.
- Example: if a player draws out of turn, and the next player then draws after that player has completed their draw-and-discard and mixes the tile into the concealed hand, the original draw order can no longer be restored.
    - In that case, even if someone complains, the referee cannot compensate the other players for the lost draw opportunity.

5. This principle applies to ordinary infractions that opponents would normally be able to notice. It does not apply to serious cheating or deliberate concealment.

6. The tournament includes three mahjong rule sets:

- 13-Tile Classical Hong Kong Mahjong
- 16-Tile New Style Mahjong (Hong Kong / Taiwanese style)
- Riichi Mahjong (Japanese mahjong)

Composition of the Mahjong Tiles

1. General setup

- A standard set of 136 tiles is used. Depending on the rules, 8 flower tiles may also be used.
- The 136 tiles are divided into suited tiles and honor tiles.

2. Suited tiles

- The suited tiles are Dots, Bamboos, and Characters.
- Each suit has ranks 1 through 9.
- There are 27 distinct suited tiles in total, with four copies of each.

3. Honor tiles

- The wind tiles are East, South, West, and North.
- The dragon tiles are Red, Green, and White.
- There are 7 distinct honor tiles in total, with four copies of each.

Objective of a Mahjong Hand

1. The object is to complete a winning hand. At the start of the match, seats and the initial dealer are determined first, and then the prescribed number of hands is played.

2. Each hand proceeds as follows:

- Shuffle, open the wall, and deal.
- Play the hand.
- If someone wins, scoring is carried out.
- If the wall runs out of tiles before anyone wins, the hand is a draw.

Note: When terminology is shown as "Riichi term or rule (other mahjong term or rule)", the same convention applies throughout.

Tile Groupings

Melds

1. Sequences, triplets, and kongs are collectively called melds.

2. Sequence: three consecutive tiles of the same suit form a sequence. A concealed sequence is formed from three concealed tiles in hand; an open sequence is formed by Chow or by winning on another player's discard.

3. Triplet: three identical tiles form a triplet. A concealed triplet is formed from three concealed tiles in hand; an open triplet is formed by Pung or by winning on another player's discard.

4. Kong: four identical tiles become a kong only when declared as a kong. Four identical concealed tiles do not count as a kong unless they are declared.

5. Pair: two identical tiles form a pair.

Winning Hand Shapes

1. Standard winning hand shape:

- Four melds plus one pair (the "eyes").

2. Special winning hand shape:

- Thirteen Orphans.

3. A hand must satisfy either the standard winning shape or a special winning shape in order to win.

4. Meeting the conditions for a scoring pattern (fan) alone is not enough. If the hand shape is invalid, the hand cannot win and it is treated as a false win.

Phases of a Hand

A mahjong hand consists of three phases:

• Dealing phase

• Play phase

• Settlement phase

The details of each phase are as follows:

Dealing Phase

1. This phase includes rolling dice, shuffling, opening the wall, and dealing. See the section “Seating and Dealing.”

2. Players may not perform play-phase actions during the dealing phase, including drawing, discarding, or calling. The dealer’s first-turn extra draw is the only exception. If such conduct harms another player’s interests, including causing a missed call opportunity or preventing correction of a dealing error, a penalty may be imposed.

3. The dealing phase ends and the play phase begins when all players have completed dealing, including confirming that the tile counts are correct, or when a player clearly indicates an imminent draw, discard, or call, waits a reasonable reaction time, and then discards (if dealer), touches the live wall (if a non-dealer), or exposes the calling tiles (if calling), without anyone objecting that dealing is incomplete.

> • If no one makes such a clear indication, then when North first touches the live wall on North’s first turn, or discards / exposes tiles after a call, the start of the play phase is retroactively recognized as the moment East made the first discard of the hand. At that point, dealing errors are no longer correctable and prior draw / call actions are treated as legal.

Play Phase

1. The dealer discards the first tile.

2. Play then proceeds through each player’s turn. Players draw, discard, and make calls until someone wins or the hand ends in a draw. Declaring a win is a play-phase action. Once the settlement phase has begun, any later win declaration is invalid.

3. The play phase ends and the settlement phase begins when:

> • A player declares a win and, after a reasonable reaction time, the hand automatically proceeds to settlement.
>
> • No tiles remain to draw and, after a reasonable reaction time, the dealer declares tenpai / noten under Riichi rules, or all four players begin shuffling for the next hand. The hand then automatically proceeds to settlement.

4. To obtain the right to win, a player must declare the win during the play phase. Even a false-win declaration causes the hand to enter settlement, making any later win declaration invalid.

Settlement Phase

1. If someone has won, the applicable scoring and record-keeping method for the rule set is carried out.

2. If the wall is exhausted and no one has won, the hand is a draw.

3. Once the settlement is confirmed as correct and scoring has been properly executed, complaints about false wins will no longer be accepted.

Reaction Time

1. Reaction time is an important standard for determining the current phase of the hand and whether declarations are valid.

2. Reaction time is not thinking time. It means the interval between another player's declaration and your almost-reflexive response declaration to resist it, such as Pung to block Chow, first-call priority to block another win, or stating that dealing has not been completed. Any thinking, including evaluating whether to Pung to stop a Chow or estimating the value of another player's hand, must occur within that reaction time. Calls must therefore be clearly and promptly declared. Nonstandard interruptions such as "wait" do not stop play.

3. For calls, a player may wait until the discarder has placed the discard face up and fully removed their fingers from it before making the response declaration. If the discarder has not placed the tile clearly, a longer gap may still be treated as valid.

Seating and Dealing

Dice Counting

The following "dice counting" procedure is used for seating and for opening the wall:

1. Roll two standard six-sided dice.

2. Count starting with the roller as 1 and proceed counterclockwise. The seat reached by the total is the result.

- Totals of 5 or 9 point to the roller.
- Totals of 2, 6, or 10 point to the player on the roller's right (next player in counterclockwise order).
- Totals of 3, 7, or 11 point to the player across from the roller.
- Totals of 4, 8, or 12 point to the player on the roller's left.

Dealer and Winds

1. Within a hand, the four seats are East, South, West, and North in counterclockwise order starting from the dealer.

2. Seat wind: the wind corresponding to your current seat. Seat winds change when the deal passes. Opening-wall dice do not change seat winds.

3. Dealer: East is also called the dealer; the other three are non-dealers.

4. Initial dealer: during seat assignment, the player who draws East becomes the first dealer and rolls the dice to determine the opening position.

5. Passing the deal: after a hand ends, if East wins, or in certain draw situations, East remains dealer. Otherwise, the previous South becomes the next dealer. In one complete rotation, each player has one chance to be dealer.

6. Round / wind cycle: after the dealership has passed four times and the original dealer becomes dealer again, one wind round has been completed.

7. Round wind: the first cycle is East round, the second is South round, and so on. Round wind and seat wind can both score and may stack.

Opening the Wall

1. The dealer rolls the dice. Using the dice-counting procedure, one player is designated as the wall opener, and the same total is the opening number.

2. On the opener's wall, count that many stacks from right to left (clockwise) and set them aside as the dead wall / kong tail. The wall to the left of those stacks becomes the live wall.

3. Note that tiles are drawn from the live wall clockwise, which is different from the counterclockwise turn order of play.

4. Seat winds and passing the deal are not affected by the opening-wall dice.

Dealing

1. After opening the wall, dealing begins.

2. For the first hand, the designated East is the dealer. Thereafter, East is determined by the passing-the-deal rules.

3. East first takes two stacks (four tiles) from the live wall; then South, West, and North do the same in order.

4. Continue taking tiles in the prescribed manner until each player has the required number. Then replace flowers if flowers are in use. If flowers are not used, skip directly to step 8.

5. East replaces flowers first by setting them aside and drawing replacement tiles from the dead wall. After East finishes, East asks South to replace flowers, then West, then North.

6. If a replacement tile is also a flower, that player waits until the other players have finished replacing flowers, and then flower replacement starts again from East.

7. Once South, West, and North have all finished replacing flowers, East discards. Depending on the rules, players may also be allowed to make certain declarations, such as Heavenly Ready, before play continues.

8. Before the deal is confirmed as correct, players should not inspect the faces of their hand tiles or the underside of drawn tiles. Otherwise, if the deal is wrong, a penalty may be imposed.

Table Areas

1. Wall: before dealing, each player has a row of unrevealed tiles in front of them. Tiles are stacked face down in two-tile stacks to form the wall.

2. River / discard pool: the central area enclosed by the walls where discards are placed. Each player arranges their own discards from left to right, face up. Under Riichi rules, discards are arranged six per row; other rules have no such limit.

3. Concealed hand: the area outside the wall containing tiles that have been taken but not discarded and not revealed. Each player keeps a row of concealed tiles with the tile faces toward themselves.

4. Open tiles / exposed melds: the area at the lower right of the concealed hand (or lower left / in front of it, depending on the table layout), where called melds and concealed kongs are placed.

Turn Sequence

Discarding

1. After dealing is complete, East first draws and then discards one tile. If no one calls, the turn passes to the player on East's right.

2. Turn: one player's full draw-and-discard sequence is one turn. A turn consists of:

- Draw stage: draw one tile from the live wall.
- Arrangement stage: the player may declare self-draw, kong, riichi, or choose to do nothing.
- Discard stage: discard one tile.
- Call stage: the other players decide whether to call or win on that discard.

3. A full cycle means the period from the end of one player's turn to the end of that same player's next turn.

4. When a call is made, play goes directly to the caller's discard stage, and then to the turn of the player on the caller's right, or to the next caller's discard stage if a higher-priority call is made.

5. Play continues in this manner until someone wins or the hand ends in a draw.

Draw-and-Discard Rules

1. Before the player to your left has discarded, you must not reach to draw a tile or reach into the discard area in a way that obstructs others. Drawing before your turn is an early draw and is penalized.

2. The next player should ensure that the previous player's discard has been placed face up and released so that all players can see it clearly before reaching to draw.

3. Once the next player touches the live wall, that player is deemed to have passed on making a call. The other two players may still call.

4. If a player declares a kong and forgets to draw the supplement tile, and the next player draws and mixes the tile into the concealed hand, or the caller has already discarded after the call, the mistake can no longer be corrected and the player continues with a small dead hand. If discovered earlier, it is treated as discard-before-draw.

5. After a discard is made, if the next player has already drawn and mixed the tile into the concealed hand, or has already discarded, declared a win, or declared a kong, the other two players lose the right to call the previous discard.

6. Discards must be placed in the center of the table within the area enclosed by the walls.

7. A tile may be called only after it has clearly been discarded into the river.

8. Once a discard has clearly entered the river area, it may not be taken back into the concealed hand.

9. If a player accidentally drops a tile into the river, that tile is not automatically treated as a discard. The player may take it back, but a penalty may be imposed.

10. Discards must be arranged neatly. When one row is full, start a new row beneath it. Tiles taken by calls are an exception.

11. Players are discouraged from reading aloud the name of the tile they discard. If a wrong spoken tile name causes an opponent to make an incorrect call, a penalty may be imposed.

12. A player is not obliged to reveal whether the discarded tile was just drawn or from which position in the concealed hand it came, and may intentionally conceal that information. Opponents may observe this and use it strategically, but they do so at their own risk. Such information is not legally binding. Collusive signaling through discard position is strictly prohibited.

In-Play Calls

Calls

1. A call means taking another player's most recent discard in order to win or complete a set. Calls include Ron / win on discard, Chow, Pung, and big exposed kong. A call is made during the call stage of the discarder's turn, and is followed immediately by the caller's discard stage.

2. Calls may be made in Cantonese, Mandarin, English, or Japanese, depending on the event language policy.

3. Only the most recently discarded tile can be called. Once the next player has drawn and mixed a tile into the concealed hand, the discard can no longer be called.

4. When calling to complete a set, the full set must be exposed as an open meld. The called tile may not simply be added back into the concealed hand.

5. There are four kinds of call: win on discard, Chow, Pung, and big exposed kong.

6. Only an actual call declaration counts. Other words such as "wait" or "look" may be ignored by opponents.

7. All calls must be spoken aloud.

Pung

1. If another player discards a tile identical to a pair in your hand, you may call "Pung" and combine it with your pair to form an open triplet.

2. The resulting triplet must be exposed and placed in the prescribed open-meld area where opponents can see it clearly, and it must be arranged in the required order and placement.

3. A Pung skips your draw stage and arrangement stage. After Pung, you must discard one tile, then play passes to the next player.

Chow

1. If the player on your left discards a tile that can combine with two tiles in your hand to form a sequence, you may call “Chow” and use it to form an open sequence. Unlike Pung or a winning call, Chow is allowed only on the discard of the player on your left.

2. The resulting sequence must be exposed and placed in the prescribed open-meld area.

3. A Chow skips your draw stage and arrangement stage. After Chow, you must discard one tile, then play passes to the next player.

4. The player making the Chow should first call “Chow,” then expose the sequence, then take in the discarded tile, and only then discard.

5. During a reasonable reaction time after “Chow” is called, other players still retain the right to Pung or Kong that tile. Therefore, after calling Chow, the player should wait briefly before exposing the sequence. Once the sequence has been exposed after a reasonable pause, the Chow is fixed and the others lose the right to Pung or Kong that tile. If the player fails to say “Chow,” or exposes the sequence immediately without any pause after calling it, a Pung / Kong may still be made within a reasonable reaction time.

Kong

1. Four identical tiles become a kong when a kong is declared. There are three kinds of kong: concealed kong, added kong, and big exposed kong. The player declaring the kong should say “Kong.” Added kong and big exposed kong are both open kongs.

2. Concealed kong: during the arrangement stage, if you have four identical tiles in your concealed hand, you may declare a concealed kong. However, you may not simultaneously Chow / Pung and also declare a kong.

3. Added kong: during the arrangement stage, if you have a tile in your concealed hand identical to one of your existing open triplets, you may add it to make a kong. After saying “Kong,” expose the tile.

4. Once a player has already discarded a tile into the river, that tile may not be taken back to make an added kong. It is recommended to say “Kong” before exposing the tile, and the added-kong tile should be placed clearly in the open-meld area behind the concealed hand. If the player neither speaks clearly nor acts clearly enough for others to know whether the action is an added kong or a discard, the next player may call that tile.

5. Big exposed kong: if another player discards a tile identical to your concealed triplet, you may call “Kong” and combine it with the triplet to form a big exposed kong.

6. All kongs must be placed in the prescribed open-meld area. Once four tiles have formed a kong, they are locked and may not later be returned to the concealed hand or rearranged as another grouping.

7. Supplement tile after a kong: after declaring a kong, draw one supplement tile from the dead wall. This is because the kong uses four tiles to form a set that would ordinarily consist of three. After drawing the supplement tile, skip the draw stage and enter or continue the arrangement stage.

8. You must first expose all four kong tiles clearly and confirm them before drawing the supplement tile. Drawing the supplement tile before exposing the kong is prohibited and may be ruled a major dead hand.

Robbing a Kong

1. If an opponent makes an added kong using the tile you are waiting on, you may call win and take that tile. This is called robbing a kong.

2. Normally only an added kong may be robbed. A concealed kong may not be robbed, except that under Classical Hong Kong rules, Thirteen Orphans may rob a concealed kong. For a big exposed kong, winning takes priority under the call-priority rules, so the kong does not stand.

3. As soon as an opponent adds the tile to an open triplet, you may immediately call win to rob the kong. You should not wait until after the supplement draw. Likewise, the player making the added kong should wait a reasonable reaction time after declaring the kong before drawing the supplement tile.

4. If a player merely intends to discard a tile and not to declare a kong, the tile must be placed clearly in the river in front of the concealed hand. It must not be placed in the open-meld area behind the concealed hand. Otherwise, whether or not “Kong” was said, the action may be treated as an added kong and therefore subject to robbing.

Winning

1. Self-draw: when it is your turn and you draw a winning tile from the live wall, you may call “Self-draw” and expose your hand to declare a self-draw win. This declaration occurs during the arrangement stage.

2. Win on discard: when another player discards a tile you are waiting for, or adds a kong with a tile you are waiting for, you may call “Win” and expose your hand. This is a win on discard, and the player who provided the tile is said to have dealt in. A win on discard occurs during the call stage.

3. When a player wins, the entire hand must be exposed for the three opponents to inspect for scoring. Before all three opponents have confirmed that the hand shape is correct, no one should disturb any tiles on the table. Otherwise, the hand may be treated as a false win and the player will bear the penalty.

Settlement After Winning

1. After exposing the hand, the winner should arrange the tiles according to the hand shape so that all players can verify the win and score it.

2. For a standard winning hand, the four melds and the pair should be separated and displayed clearly.

3. For Thirteen Orphans and similar special hands, tiles should be arranged in order by terminal suited tiles, winds, and dragons.

4. For seven-pairs-type presentations where applicable, identical tiles should be placed adjacent to each other.

5. For a self-draw win, place the winning tile sideways beside the hand to indicate it. Do not insert it into the body of the hand. For a win on discard, the winning tile need not be physically taken into the hand.

Call Priority

1. If two or more players attempt to call the same discard, only the highest-priority legal call stands.

2. Priority from highest to lowest is: win > Pung or Kong > Chow.

3. Only legal calls have priority. If a call is invalid, opponents may cancel that priority and take the tile with a valid call.

4. A player who wants priority for Pung or Kong should call promptly. A player making a Chow should normally say “Chow,” wait a reasonable reaction time, and only then expose the sequence. If the Chow sequence is exposed after such a pause, the Chow is fixed and others lose the right to Pung / Kong. If the player fails to say “Chow,” or exposes immediately without pausing, a Pung / Kong may still take the tile within a reasonable reaction time.

5. A player making a Chow must call first and discard afterward. If the player discards before calling and in doing so exposes information from the hand, a penalty may be imposed.

6. If a legal call is superseded by a higher-priority legal call from another player, the original caller is not penalized even if tiles have already been exposed.

7. If a player calls Chow and another opponent then uses a higher-priority Pung or Kong declaration, the player who called Chow may switch to a winning declaration if the rules allow.

8. If a player waits until after a reasonable reaction time to invoke priority and call, that is treated as a cancelled call or empty win and is penalized.

Prohibited Calls

1. Even if a player previously passed on Pung, or broke up a concealed triplet and discarded one of its tiles, calling Pung on a later copy of that tile before the next draw is still legal. However, if that Pung would create package-payment liability, including Big Three Dragons package payment or 12-open-tiles package payment, it is prohibited.

2. Likewise, even if a player broke up a concealed sequence and discarded one of its tiles, calling Chow on a later relevant discard before the next draw is still legal, unless that Chow would create package-payment liability, in which case it is prohibited.

Placement of Open Melds

1. The open-meld area is at the lower left of the concealed hand, in the corner area on the table. All called melds and concealed kongs must be placed there.

2. Open melds may not be placed arbitrarily. They must be arranged in the order in which they were called. Otherwise, the referee may prohibit the player from winning.

Winning a Hand

1. To win, the hand must satisfy the standard winning shape or a special winning shape. Satisfying the conditions for fan alone is not enough. Otherwise it is a false win.

- Standard winning shape: four melds and one pair.
- Special winning shape: Thirteen Orphans.

2. Self-draw means drawing the winning tile from the wall on your own turn.

3. Win on discard means another player discards the tile you are waiting for and you call win on it.

4. If two or more players call win on the same discard, simultaneous wins are allowed.

5. Minimum winning threshold: the hand must contain at least 3 fan in order to win.

6. As a general rule, a player may win as long as the hand shape is valid and the minimum fan requirement is met. However, a player may not win on a repeat tile within the same cycle where the rules prohibit it.

Scoring a Win

1. The hand should be arranged by hand shape for all players to verify and score it.

2. For a standard winning hand, separate the four sets and the pair.

3. For Thirteen Orphans, arrange the tiles by suit, winds, and dragons.

4. After every win, the referee should be called to score the hand. All four players have a responsibility to check that the scoring is correct. Once the referee asks for confirmation and records the score on the score sheet, the players may shuffle. No player may mix up the tiles before all four have confirmed the score. After that confirmation, requests to revise the score will not be accepted.

5. If the same winning hand can be interpreted in two or more ways, it is scored using the interpretation that yields the highest number of fan.

Drawn Hand

1. If the final tile of the live wall has been drawn and the player who drew it then discards with no one winning on that discard, the hand is a draw.

2. On a draw, the dealer does not continue as dealer under these tournament rules, including at North 4.

End of a Round

1. One round consists of four complete wind cycles. After those four cycles are finished, the round ends immediately regardless of the current dealership streak.

2. The official time limit for one round is 100 minutes. If time expires while a hand is in progress, the current hand becomes the last hand of the round.

3. The maximum number of hands in one round is 24. If that limit is reached before North 4, the current hand becomes the last hand of the round.

4. At the end of the round, the four players must verify the total scores and then sign in the designated area of the score sheet. A signature means agreement that the scoring is correct. After signing, neither the referee nor any player bears responsibility for scoring errors.

5. If there is a scoring dispute, the players may request a ruling from the referee. The referee’s decision is final.

Fouls and Penalties

1. The following rules apply to unintentional or careless errors. The referee may impose additional punishment for deliberate fouls.

2. Depending on the circumstances and seriousness, the referee may impose penalties such as:

- Prohibition from winning this hand
- Deduction of X points
- Yellow card or red card
- Disqualification and removal from the venue
- Placement on a blacklist barring future participation
- Any other penalty the referee considers appropriate

3. Prohibition from winning this hand: once a player is prohibited from winning for the current hand, that player may not call or win again for the rest of the hand, except where flower wins are separately allowed. Any violation is treated as a false win.

4. First offense: the first violation of a given rule within one round counts as a first offense. Different kinds of infractions are tracked separately. At the end of a round, except for deliberate fouls and red cards, the player's record resets.

5. Yellow card: a yellow card remains in effect until the end of the round and immediately deducts 24 points. Receiving another yellow card while one is already in effect is treated as a red card.

6. Red card: a red card remains in effect until the end of that day's event and immediately deducts 96 points. Receiving another red card while one is already in effect deducts 512 more points.

Fouls During Dealing

The following rules apply to unintentional or careless errors during the dealing phase. The referee may correct the situation or impose additional punishment for deliberate misconduct.

1. Wrong dealer: if the wrong player starts dealing from the wall, and the mistake is found before anyone looks at their tiles or the underside of a tile, dealing is corrected so the proper dealer takes first. If the mistake is found before everyone has taken 12 tiles, dealing continues until each player has 12 tiles, then the correct dealer takes the dealer's extra draw and play continues. If discovered only after the wrong dealer has taken the extra draw, it is treated as a dealing dead hand during the first turn. After the first turn, the wrong dealer cannot be corrected and continues as dealer for that hand. In the next hand, the deal passes normally to the next player after the correct dealer; the correct dealer receives no compensation.

2. Taking the wrong tiles: if a player takes the wrong tiles during dealing but has not yet looked at the hand or the underside of the tile, the mistake may be corrected without penalty. If the player has already looked, a yellow card is imposed.

3. Dealing dead hand: all dealing dead hands must be corrected during the dealing phase. Once the play phase begins, they can no longer be corrected retroactively. If a player notices before looking at the tiles that the tile count is wrong, the player may take missing tiles from the live wall or return extra tiles to it. After looking at part or all of the hand, if the player finds the hand short, missing tiles may still be drawn from the live wall; but if the hand has too many tiles, only tiles that have not been looked at may be returned. If there are more extra tiles than unseen tiles, all unseen tiles must be returned and the player continues with a major dead hand.

4. Discarding during the dealing phase: if a player discards during dealing and causes others to miss a call or lose the chance to correct a dealing dead hand, the referee may penalize all players who have already discarded. The dealing dead hand may still be corrected, but missed call opportunities are not restored.

5. Redeal: if an uncorrectable error occurs during dealing such that the hand can no longer proceed fairly, the referee may order a redeal, with new shuffling, new dice, and a new opening of the wall. Once the play phase has begun, there can be no redeal.

Fouls When Drawing

The following rules apply to unintentional or careless errors while drawing. The referee may correct the situation or impose additional punishment for deliberate misconduct.

1. Exposing another player's hand: if a player flips over another player's hand tiles, the penalty is a red card.

2. Discard before draw: failing to perform the required draw or kong supplement before discarding. If discovered before the next player / caller discards, the missed draw may be made up, but a yellow card is imposed. If discovered afterward, the draw may not be made up and the player continues with a small dead hand.

3. Early draw: if a player draws before the previous player has discarded, and the tile has not yet been mixed into the concealed hand, the penalty is a yellow card. If it has already been mixed in, the penalty is a red card plus prohibition from winning.

4. Wrong draw: if a player draws from anywhere other than the live wall and has already looked at the wrongly drawn tile or its underside, the wrong draw stands and a yellow card is imposed. If another player points it out before that player discards, the wrongly drawn tile must be discarded. After the player has discarded, the error cannot be corrected retroactively. The tile that should originally have been drawn from the live wall is moved by the referee to fill the gap created by the wrong draw, and future draws continue from the live wall as normal.

5. Flipping tiles in the wall: if a player flips over tiles in the wall, the first exposed tile is excused without penalty on the first offense; otherwise a yellow card is imposed. Repeated violations in the same half-round each receive a yellow card.

6. Improperly exposing one's own hand: if a player exposes tiles from the concealed hand and at least one other player has seen them, those tiles are treated as exposed tiles. If they remain in the concealed hand after that turn, they count as improperly exposed hand tiles. Improperly exposed tiles may not be used as calling tiles, including for a winning wait. Penalties depend on the number of tiles exposed: 1 tile = yellow card; 2 tiles = red card; 3 or more tiles = yellow plus red card; exposing half or more of the concealed hand (fewer than 4 tiles still counts if it is half or more) = false win.

7. Disrupting the table: if a player seriously disturbs the tiles on the table so that the hand cannot continue, the referee will impose a penalty according to the circumstances. This is generally treated severely.

Fouls During Play

The following penalties apply to unintentional or careless errors during play. The referee may correct the situation or impose additional punishment for deliberate misconduct.

1. Incorrect call immediately corrected: if a player makes a call and exposes the set but immediately discovers the call is invalid, such as trying to Chow from the wrong player, the player may correct it immediately. Any exposed tiles caused by the mistaken call are penalized under the rules on improperly exposed hand tiles. If there is suspicion of collusion, such as intentionally revealing the shape of a ready hand, the referee may impose a heavier penalty.

2. Call-and-change discard (食换): if after a Pung a player discards another copy of that same tile, or after a Chow discards a tile that would re-form a concealed sequence with the two tiles used for the Chow, a yellow card is imposed. If the next player has not yet drawn and no one has called or won on that discard, the offender must take back the illegal discard and discard a legal tile instead; any resulting exposed tiles are handled under the improper-exposure rules. If the next player has already drawn, or someone has called or won on that discard, the offender is prohibited from winning.

3. Changing a call: if a player calls Chow, Pung, or Kong and then tries to change to a different type of call or to a win, a yellow card is imposed. However, if another opponent makes a higher-priority legal call under the priority rules, the original caller may switch to a win without penalty if allowed.

4. Silent call: if a player makes a call without speaking it aloud, other players may ignore it, and the call does not receive priority under the call-priority rules. If the other players nevertheless allow the call to proceed, a yellow card is imposed once the called set becomes fixed.

5. Discard before draw: failing to perform the required draw or kong supplement before discarding. If discovered before the next player / caller discards, the missed draw may be made up, but a yellow card is imposed. If discovered afterward, the draw may not be made up and the player continues with a small dead hand.

6. Dropping a tile into the river: if a player accidentally drops a tile into the river, the tile is not automatically treated as a discard. The player may take it back, but any exposure is penalized under the improper-exposure rules.

7. Flipping one’s own hand tile: if a player accidentally flips one of their own tiles face up, the tile may be returned, but any exposure is penalized under the improper-exposure rules. If too many tiles are exposed, the action may be treated as a false win.

8. Winning after another player has already supplemented or redrawn: if a player attempts, after a big exposed kong supplement draw, to win on the tile that was taken for the kong; or declares robbing a kong only after the added-kong player has already drawn the supplement tile; or declares a win on the previous discard only after the next drawn tile has been discarded, the penalty is a yellow card and a 16-point deduction.

9. Cancelling a call: if a player calls Chow, Pung, or big exposed Kong and in fact has a legal set with which to do so, the player must complete the call. If the player calls and then discovers there is no legal set, the call is cancelled and a yellow card is imposed.

10. Incorrect exposed set: if a player makes a Chow, Pung, or Kong and later - after the discard has been called, the next player has drawn, or the supplement tile has been drawn - it is discovered that the exposed set does not actually form a legal sequence, triplet, or kong, the mistake cannot be corrected and the player is prohibited from winning for that hand. The same applies if a kong is later found to be invalid after the supplement draw.

11. False win: if a player intentionally pushes down the entire hand but the hand cannot actually win, it is a false win even if the player retracts it before others notice. Likewise, if a player topples enough of a non-

winning concealed hand for at least one opponent to remember half or more of it, even unintentionally, that is also a false win. The usual penalty is deduction of limit-hand points (512), the hand is reset, and the same dealer deals again.

12. Empty win: if a player declares a win but changes their mind or discovers the hand cannot win before fully exposing the hand, the win declaration is cancelled and a red card is imposed.

13. It is the responsibility of the three opponents to confirm that the winner has a correct winning hand shape. Before a win is confirmed, opponents should not expose their own hands or disturb any tiles on the table. If the supposed win turns out to be empty, the hand must continue, and anyone who improperly exposed tiles or disturbed the table may also be penalized.

Dead Hand (Xianggong)

1. If a player is found to have the wrong number of tiles in hand, that player loses the right to win for the rest of the hand. This is called a dead hand (xianggong).

2. If the hand has too few tiles, it is a small dead hand. The player is prohibited from winning and receives a yellow card.

3. If the hand has too many tiles, it is a major dead hand. The player is prohibited from winning, including flower wins, and receives a yellow card. In addition, starting from the second extra tile, each extra tile incurs a 24-point deduction.

4. Once a player has been confirmed as a dead hand, the prohibition on winning remains even if the tile count later returns to the correct number.

5. These penalties apply to dead hands caused by carelessness. The referee may correct the situation or impose additional punishment for deliberate acts, such as intentionally drawing extra tiles, refusing to discard, or discarding multiple tiles at once.

Other Misconduct

1. During a hand, players should not speak except to make formal calls. If the referee believes a player's speech hinders play or disturbs others, a yellow card or heavier penalty may be imposed.

2. Verbal abuse or physical gestures that harass other players may be punished with a yellow card or more severe penalties.

3. If a player needs to use an electronic communication device for an emergency during play, the player must notify the referee. If the referee believes a player is asking to use such a device for a non-emergency reason, or is using it too frequently, a yellow card or heavier penalty may be imposed.

4. Cheating, colluding with other players or the referee, or engaging in any form of gambling is strictly prohibited. Once discovered, the player will be immediately disqualified and blacklisted from future events. Serious cases may be referred to law enforcement.

Score Calculation

Basic Scoring Principles

1. Only a winning hand scores. The winner receives the corresponding points from the other three players according to the point transfer method.

2. Full-combination principle: if a hand satisfies the conditions for multiple fan patterns, the values are generally added together to determine the hand's fan count. Unless expressly stated otherwise, all necessarily coexisting fan may stack. For example, Under the Sea may be added to Self-Draw, and Big Three Dragons may be added to Dragon Pungs.

3. Minimum winning threshold: a hand must have at least 3 fan to win.

4. Limit and maximum fan: 10 fan is the cap. Any limit hand is counted as 10 fan.

Point Transfer Method

1. Full payment on discard: when a player wins on a discard, the discarder pays the entire amount.

2. Package payment: to penalize a player who provides the critical tile that completes another player's especially dangerous hand, these tournament rules use package payment. When package payment applies, the liable player alone pays all of the points that the winner would otherwise receive from three players on a self-draw. The other two players pay nothing. If the hand wins on discard, however, the discarder alone still pays as usual.

- 12-open-tiles package payment: when a player has reached twelve open tiles, meaning four exposed sets in total (including open triplets, open sequences, and all types of kong), the player who provided the fourth exposed set pays the self-draw amount alone. If the fourth exposed set was a concealed kong, no one is liable.

- Big Three Dragons package payment: when a player has exposed sets of Red, Green, and White dragons, the player who provided the third dragon set pays the self-draw amount alone. If the third exposed dragon set was a concealed kong, no one is liable.

3. Later package overrides earlier package: at most one player can be liable for package payment on a winning hand. If more than one package condition would apply, only the later one to have arisen is recognized.

4. Robbing a kong counts as self-draw for payment: robbing a kong is treated as though the konging player dealt in, with 1 extra fan added, but payment is calculated using the self-draw payment structure. It also overrides any package-payment liability that would otherwise have applied.

List of Fan

1 Fan

- 1.1 All Sequences (Ping Wu / Pinfu): the hand contains four sequences and no triplets or kongs.

- 1.2 Concealed Hand: all tiles are concealed at the time of winning, with no exposed sets. Concealed kongs count as exposed for this purpose.

- 1.3 Self-Draw: the winning tile was drawn by the player.

• 1.4 Dragon Pung: a triplet of Red, Green, or White dragons.

• 1.5 Wind Pung: a triplet of the player's seat wind or the current round wind. If seat wind and round wind are the same wind, it counts as 2 fan.

• 1.6 Terminals and Honors: the hand consists only of terminals (1s and 9s) and honors. This fan is added together with All Triplets.

• 1.7 Robbing a Kong: the winning tile is a tile used by another player to declare a kong. Generally only an added kong may be robbed; only Thirteen Orphans may rob a concealed kong.

• 1.8 Kong-On-Self-Draw: winning immediately on the supplement tile after declaring a kong.

• 1.9 Under the Sea: self-drawing the final tile of the wall.

3 Fan

• 2.1 Half Flush: all tiles are from one suit plus honors.

• 2.2 All Triplets: the hand contains four triplets / kongs and no sequences.

• 2.3 Little Three Dragons: two dragon triplets / kongs plus a pair of the third dragon. Dragon Pung fan is also added, so this is effectively 5 fan.

5 Fan

• 4.1 Big Three Dragons: three dragon triplets / kongs. Dragon Pung fan is also added, so this is effectively 8 fan.

7 Fan

• 5.1 Full Flush: all tiles are from a single suit, with no honors.

Limit Hands (10 Fan)

• 6.1 All Honors: the hand consists entirely of honor tiles.

• 6.2 Little Four Winds: three wind triplets / kongs plus a pair of the fourth wind.

• 6.3 Big Four Winds: four wind triplets / kongs.

• 6.4 Four Concealed Triplets: also called Concealed All Triplets. The hand has four concealed triplets, with no kongs. A single wait may win on discard; a pair wait must be self-drawn.

• 6.5 Eighteen Arhats: the hand contains four kongs.

• 6.6 Pure Terminals: the hand consists entirely of suited terminal tiles (1s and 9s), with no honors.

• 6.7 Heavenly Hand: East wins directly on the initial dealt hand. A concealed kong voids Heavenly Hand.

• 6.8 Earthly Hand: a non-dealer's initial 13 tiles are already waiting, and the player wins on East's very first discard. If East has declared a concealed kong, it does not count.

• 6.9 Thirteen Orphans: one pair among the thirteen terminal and honor tile types, plus one of each of the other twelve types.

• 6.10 Kong-on-Kong Self-Draw: winning after declaring two consecutive kongs.

• 6.11 Nine Gates: a concealed single-suit hand of 1112345678999 plus any one tile of the same suit. On self-draw, completion of the pattern is enough; on a win by discard, the wait must be on all nine possible tiles.

Points Conversion Table

The source rulebook states that points are calculated on a “100-base, half-lah-up” basis. The conversion table given in the rulebook is reproduced below in English.

Fan	Total Points	Self-Draw Payment
3	32	16 x 3
4	64	32 x 3
5	96	48 x 3
6	128	64 x 3
7	192	96 x 3
8	256	128 x 3
9	384	192 x 3
10	512	256 x 3

Copyright Notice

The Hong Kong Mahjong Association ("the Association") owns the copyright in all content of these rules.

All copyrighted content and information contained in these rules may be freely viewed, displayed, downloaded, printed, and published, provided that the original format of the rules is preserved, that the content is identified as belonging to the Association, and that this copyright notice is reproduced in all copies.

The Association reserves all rights not expressly granted in this notice.

If any organizer wishes to reproduce any content of these rules for any form of mahjong competition, the Association requests that an application be emailed before event promotion begins, with the subject line:

[Application to Borrow Mahjong Rules]: [Organizer Name] [Event Name] [Event Date]

Applications should be sent to info@hkmahjong.org.

In general, the Association does not refuse such applications. However, if any person uses the content of these rules without applying first, the Association reserves the right to pursue the matter.

Any person wishing to use the above content for any other purpose not approved above must first obtain the Association’s written consent. Such requests may also be sent to info@hkmahjong.org.